

FREE RESOURCE | nuBeam Partners

The 8 Investor Deployment Signals We Track Every Day

Know exactly when investors are actively deploying — before you ever send the first email.

Why Timing Beats Everything

Most investor outreach fails not because of a bad pitch — but because it arrives at the wrong moment. Investors have **active deployment windows**. Inside those windows, they're ready to move. Outside them, it doesn't matter how polished your deck is.

At nuBeam Partners, we monitor 8 specific signals that tell us when a particular investor is in an active window *right now*. These are the same signals that took our reply rates from 3% to **22%+ positive** — without changing a single word of copy.

The 8 Signals

SIGNAL 01

Recent Portfolio Announcements

WHAT TO TRACK

Track the frequency of a fund's new deal announcements over the last 60 days. Three or more announcements = actively deploying.

WHY IT MATTERS

Funds announce deals publicly when they're proud of them and want deal flow. A cluster of announcements is the clearest possible sign they're in an open window right now.

HOW TO FIND IT — STEP BY STEP

1. Go to the fund's website and check their 'Portfolio' or 'News' page — sort by date and count announcements in the last 60 days.
2. Search LinkedIn: type the fund name + 'excited to announce' or 'thrilled to invest' and filter by 'Past month'.
3. Set a free Google Alert: go to [google.com/alerts](https://www.google.com/alerts) → enter "[Fund Name] investment" or "[Fund Name] portfolio" → set frequency to 'As it happens'.
4. Check Crunchbase ([crunchbase.com](https://www.crunchbase.com)) — search the fund, click 'Investments', sort by date. Free tier shows recent activity.

SIGNAL 02

Form D SEC Filings

WHAT TO TRACK

Public filings submitted to the SEC when a fund raises new LP capital. A fresh Form D means fresh deployment mandate.

WHY IT MATTERS

When a fund files a Form D, it has just closed new LP capital. That capital has a timeline and a deployment mandate. This is among the most reliable signals available — and almost nobody outside institutional finance is using it.

HOW TO FIND IT — STEP BY STEP

1. Go to efits.sec.gov/LATEST/search-index?q=%22fund+name%22&dateRange;=custom&startdt;=2024-01-01&enddt;=2024-12-31&forms;=D — or simply visit sec.gov → click 'EDGAR Full-Text Search'.
2. In the search box, type the fund name and set 'Form Type' to 'D'. Filter by date — look for filings in the last 6 months.
3. Each Form D shows: the total raise amount, the date filed, and whether the offering is still open.
4. Build a spreadsheet. Track fund name, filing date, amount raised. Sort by recency. Funds that filed in the last 90 days are your priority targets.
5. Bonus: search by industry/sector using the SIC codes in the filing to find new funds in your sector you didn't know existed.

SIGNAL 03

Fund Vintage Timing

WHAT TO TRACK

The year a fund completed its LP raise (the 'vintage') and where it sits in its standard 3–5 year deployment cycle.

WHY IT MATTERS

Every fund has a deployment clock. A 2022 vintage fund is now in its prime deployment window. A 2018 vintage fund is almost certainly done deploying and is in harvest mode. Knowing the vintage tells you whether the door is open before you knock.

HOW TO FIND IT — STEP BY STEP

1. Search Crunchbase or PitchBook (free tier) for the fund. Look at 'Funds' tab — it usually shows the fund size and year closed.
2. Check the fund's own website — many publish fund launch dates in their 'About' or 'Strategy' sections.
3. Cross-reference their known portfolio companies on Crunchbase. Sort investments by date — the earliest investment date is roughly when they started deploying.
4. Do the math: if Fund III closed in 2022 with \$300M and they've announced ~15 deals, they likely have meaningful dry powder. A 2019 vintage at the same size is likely 80–90% deployed.
5. LinkedIn searches for '[Fund Name] Fund III' often surface LP announcements or press releases with close dates.

SIGNAL 04

Sector Mandate Shifts

WHAT TO TRACK

Multiple investments in the same sector within a 30–90 day window, signaling the fund has an active thesis or LP mandate to deploy into that sector.

WHY IT MATTERS

Investors don't make 3 bets in the same sector by accident. It's a deliberate mandate. If your company fits that sector, you're not a cold pitch — you're the next logical conversation they should be having.

HOW TO FIND IT — STEP BY STEP

1. On Crunchbase, go to the fund's investor profile → click 'Investments' → filter by 'Investment Date' (last 90 days) → look for sector clustering.
2. Map the investments in a simple spreadsheet: Company | Sector | Date. If 3+ investments share a sector in 90 days, that's an active mandate.
3. Read recent GP blog posts, Medium articles, or partner LinkedIn posts — fund managers often telegraph where they're focusing next.
4. Check if they've published a 'thesis' post or spoken at a sector-specific conference recently. This is often a public signal of mandate direction.
5. Use the free version of The Information or TechCrunch to search '[Fund Name] + [sector]' for recent coverage.

SIGNAL 05

Co-Investment Appetite

WHAT TO TRACK

Signals that a lead investor is actively looking for co-investors or syndicate partners to fill a current deal.

WHY IT MATTERS

This is one of the warmest possible entry points. The lead investor has already done diligence. They need capital. Showing up here means you're solving a live problem, not pitching cold.

HOW TO FIND IT — STEP BY STEP

1. Monitor AngelList (angellist.com) — many GPs post co-investment opportunities in their syndicates. Search by sector or fund manager name.
2. Watch LinkedIn for language like 'syndicating this round', 'looking for co-lead', or 'opening a small allocation' — these are public signals often missed.
3. Join relevant Slack communities (e.g., Stonks, Operators & Investors) where GPs post deal-sharing opportunities in real time.
4. Build relationships with 5–10 lead investors in your sector who frequently syndicate. Once they know you're reliable and move fast, they'll bring you co-invest opportunities directly.
5. Track SPV activity on platforms like Sydecar, Assure, or Republic — active SPV creation is a strong co-investment signal.

SIGNAL 06

Personnel Changes (CIO / Allocation Head)

WHAT TO TRACK

A new Chief Investment Officer, Managing Partner, or Head of Allocations joining a fund within the last 3–6 months.

WHY IT MATTERS

New leadership resets deal flow from zero. They're not tied to their predecessor's relationships. They need to build their own pipeline fast to prove their value — which means they're in aggressive sourcing mode. This window is typically only 3–6 months long.

HOW TO FIND IT — STEP BY STEP

1. Set LinkedIn alerts for target funds: follow the firm page → turn on notifications → you'll see new hire announcements in your feed.
2. Search LinkedIn directly: '[Fund Name]' + 'Chief Investment Officer' or 'Managing Director' → filter 'People' → sort by 'Recently joined'.
3. Check press releases via Google News: search '[Fund Name] appoints' or '[Fund Name] hires' to catch formal announcements.
4. Monitor industry newsletters (Axios Pro, The Information, PE Hub) — major personnel moves at funds are often covered.
5. Once you identify a new hire, reach out within 30 days. Reference their appointment directly in your outreach. It shows awareness and creates a natural reason for the conversation.

SIGNAL 07

Endowment & Pension Performance Reports

WHAT TO TRACK

Quarterly or annual disclosures from institutional LPs (university endowments, public pensions) showing strong portfolio returns, which triggers increased alternative allocations.

WHY IT MATTERS

Strong LP performance = board-approved allocation increases = new capital flowing to GPs who then need to deploy it. There's typically a 60–90 day lag between a strong performance report and that capital reaching fund managers. That lag is your window.

HOW TO FIND IT — STEP BY STEP

1. NACUBO (nacubo.org) publishes the annual Endowment Study — track which universities reported strong returns and which alternative managers they use.
2. Public pension fund reports are freely available. Search '[State] pension fund annual report 2024' — CalPERS, CDPQ, and OTPP all publish detailed disclosures.
3. When a large LP reports strong returns, use their disclosed manager list to find which GPs they back — then reach out to those GPs in the following 60 days.
4. Follow LP relations news on Institutional Investor (institutionalinvestor.com) — they cover allocation changes and LP sentiment in real time.
5. Build a simple 'LP performance calendar' — note when major endowments and pensions typically publish reports (most are July–October for fiscal year-end). Set calendar reminders 60 days before and begin GP outreach prep.

SIGNAL 08

Conference Attendance Patterns

WHAT TO TRACK

An investor attending 3 or more sector-specific conferences within a 90-day window, indicating active sourcing mode.

WHY IT MATTERS

Investors don't attend conferences for the keynotes — they attend to source deals and meet founders. High-frequency attendance in a single sector is one of the clearest behavioral signals that they're actively building a pipeline right now.

HOW TO FIND IT — STEP BY STEP

1. Check the speaker/attendee lists for major sector conferences (e.g., SaaStr, Fintech Nexus, SuperReturn, CAIA). Most publish speaker rosters 4–6 weeks before the event.
2. Follow target investors on LinkedIn and X (Twitter) — conference attendance generates a spike in posts, photos, and commentary that is easy to spot in real time.
3. Use Google Alerts for '[Investor Name] + [conference name]' to catch press mentions and conference recaps.
4. Time your outreach to land within 3–5 days after the conference. Reference something specific from the event ('I saw you spoke at SuperReturn last week — your point on LP liquidity really resonated'). This dramatically increases reply rates.
5. Build a conference calendar for your sector: map out the 10–15 major events per year and identify which investors consistently attend. These are your highest-signal targets.

How to Use These Signals

- 1. Build your target list first.** Identify 100–200 investors who are the right fit by stage, sector, and geography. Do not start signal-tracking until you have this list.
- 2. Score each investor against the 8 signals.** Run each investor through the checklist. Prioritize those showing 3 or more active signals. These are your hot contacts.
- 3. Lead your outreach with the signal.** Don't pitch cold. Reference what you observed and why it makes this conversation relevant right now. You want them to feel like you did your homework — because you did.
- 4. Move within 72 hours.** Deployment windows close. If you identify an investor showing strong signals, reach out the same week. Waiting a month kills the opportunity.

Want Us to Do This For You?

We identify which investors are actively deploying in your sector today and get you in front of them at exactly the right moment — with full context and a reason to talk now.

Book a call → nubeampartners.com

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